Float Scam

Tell them. Keep the receipt. Clear the internet's artificial flotsam.

Report a suspicious advert or website to the right provider. Keep what you sent, when you sent it, and the acknowledgement.

Start here: verified reporting inboxes

AWS / CloudFront
trustandsafety@support.aws.com [2] [26]
Suspected abuse of AWS resources.

CMA
general.enquiries@cma.gov.uk [11]
Consumer-law or market concerns.

MHRA
devices.compliance@mhra.gov.uk [12]
Suspected non-compliant medical devices.

NCSC
report@phishing.gov.uk [6]
Forward suspicious emails; use the website form for a URL.

On your phone: SMS scams - 7726. WhatsApp checker - 07700 153424 (see page 5). [27] [29]
Instagram, Facebook, YouTube and ASA: official reporting links on page 4.



Conceptual illustration, generated for this guide. It depicts no actual website or incident.

The web needs a conscience

Speaking up should be simple enough that ordinary people will actually do it.

A miracle product. A borrowed face. A discount that seems to end every day. Another shopfront washes past, polished enough to take a payment and vague enough to leave the buyer asking who is behind it. This is the internet's artificial flotsam: the debris of manufactured credibility, inflated claims and disposable sales pitches.

The label describes a problem of deception and accountability. AI-generated material, small businesses, drop-shipping and unfamiliar domains each need to be judged on their evidence. A polished page proves little about the trader behind it.

The temptation is to scroll on. Reporting takes effort; the right inbox is difficult to find; the response may say very little. Ofcom's July 2026 audit found weak points in verification and reporting across a limited sample of advertising journeys. That is evidence of design problems, with a stated scope - not a finding that every advertiser or platform is fraudulent. [22]

The practical lever: tell the right provider

Record what you reported, exactly where it appeared, when you sent it, and any acknowledgement or decision. That creates a useful chronology: the original concern, the notification, the response and any later reappearance. A report with precise evidence gives the next reviewer a better starting point.

> Notification is a starting point for accountability.
> Hosting protections can depend on knowledge and response. Liability still needs a legal basis.
> There is no universal "you were emailed, so you have X days" rule. [5]

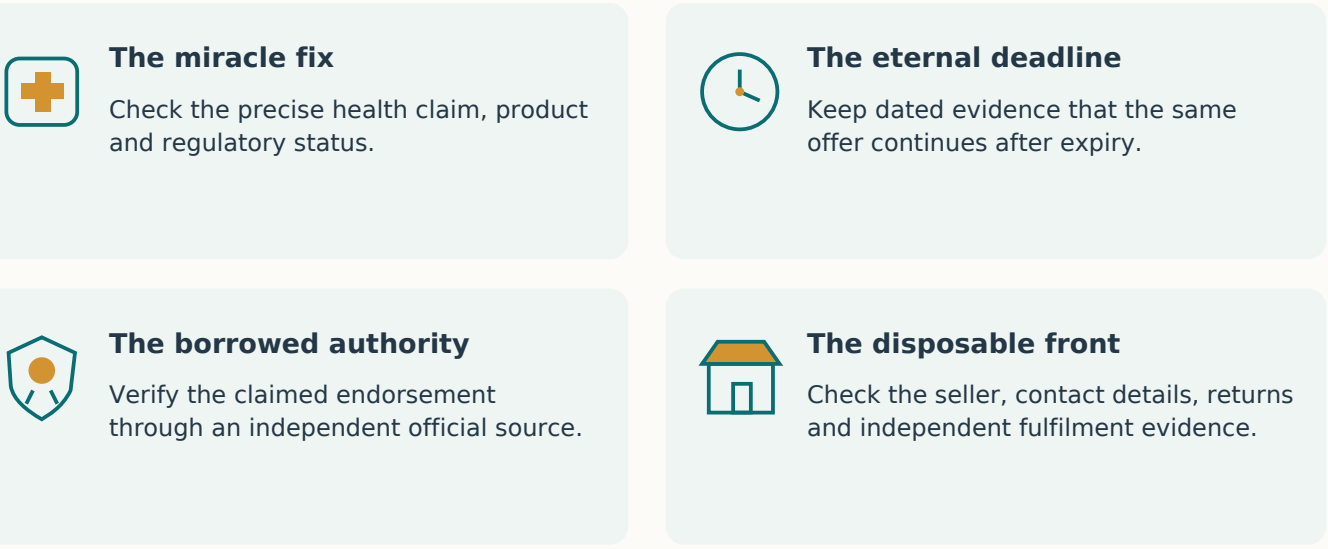
The pothole comparison captures one useful idea: notice can make a difference. Online services have their own legal tests. Some duties are proactive, and paid adverts have a separate regulatory timetable. Providers' published policies also give grounds to request an investigation now. [3] [15] [16]

We can make reporting easier while expecting businesses to do their share. Companies that sell reach, process money or supply infrastructure should give people a clear route to report abuse, a usable receipt, and a meaningful explanation of the outcome. That is the standard this guide argues for.

What Trust Check adds

Aletheia helps organise the inquiry and prepare a report that a person can review and send.

The current Aletheia Trust Check method researches identity, checks original sources, separates observations from allegations, records uncertainty and can draft a report when asked. Its static launcher hands a prompt to the user's chosen AI; live checks depend on that AI's actual tools. It is not a regulator or an automatic reporting service. [1]



Illustrated warning patterns, not evidence against any named business.

The denture advert: what is actually established?

The supplied Gemini transcript names ukbrabra.com and d27xotl7pedhdn.cloudfront.net, and describes a £35 denture offer with stock and deadline claims. These details are source-reported. No original advert capture, purchase record, demonstrated timer reset or regulatory finding was supplied. The two target pages could not be retrieved in this review.

Finding: insufficient evidence for a fraud verdict. Investigate the reported claims before repeating them as fact. A domain name, a low price or a CloudFront address does not prove dishonesty. A failed retrieval does not show that the site was removed, unsafe or non-existent.

"A front for the cloud - exactly what it says on the tin."
CloudFront is AWS's content delivery network. Its default hostname identifies a distribution, not its owner or a particular S3 bucket. The origin may be outside AWS. Use infrastructure details to route evidence; establish the connection to the reported content. [4]

Send it where it can be acted on

Choose the route that matches the evidence. One report can have several appropriate destinations.

AWS / CloudFront trustandsafety@support.aws.com AWS reporting guidance	Exact content URL and UTC/local time; explain the suspected abuse and the AWS connection. AWS prefers its form; email is an official alternative. [2] [3]
Google / YouTube Report a Google or YouTube ad	Use the advert's Report ad control or the official form. Capture advertiser/ad ID and landing-page URL. Reporting the surrounding video may miss the paid advert. [9]
Facebook / Instagram Meta's official scam-reporting links	Report the advert through its menu; retain the advertiser/page, ad or library identifier and decision. Menu labels vary. Use the appeal option if offered. [10]
ASA Report an online scam ad	For suspected paid-for scam ads. Include the ad link as well as the destination. For misleading advertising that is not an apparent scam, follow ASA's ordinary complaint route. [8]
NCSC Report a suspicious website report@phishing.gov.uk	Use the form for a website URL. Forward the original suspicious email to the inbox. NCSC assesses technical threats; this is not an individual refund service. [6]
Police / Report Fraud Report Fraud: choose the correct report 0300 123 2040	Use the suspicion or crime route as appropriate in England, Wales or Northern Ireland. Scotland: Police Scotland on 101. If money or card details are at risk, contact the bank promptly. [7]
Trading Standards / CMA Citizens Advice referral general.enquiries@cma.gov.uk	Trading Standards: unfair trading, unsafe goods and scams. CMA: wider consumer or market concerns. The CMA does not resolve individual complaints. [11] [13]
Medical devices / MHRA devices.compliance@mhra.gov.uk	Suspected device non-compliance: seller/manufacturer, product, specific concern and evidence. A medical-sounding description alone does not establish a breach. [12]
Repeated platform failures / Ofcom Ofcom online-services complaints	Report to the platform first, then supply notice/decision history and repeated exposure. Ofcom uses reports to assess systems; it does not decide individual takedowns. [19]

Report it from your phone

Choose the route for the message or advert you actually saw.

WhatsApp: 07700 153424
Metro Bank Scam Checker, powered by Ask Silver. Verify the number on Metro Bank's own website. The bank says its automated tool can check a link or image and offers a route to report suspected scams to the NCSC. [29]

A WhatsApp checking and reporting route exists

Add the published number to WhatsApp and start the conversation yourself. Review the result and choose any reporting option explicitly. This is a third-party service: a checker result or forwarding confirmation does not prove that AWS or an advertiser has received a notice. Retain whatever receipt is supplied.

Get Safe Online also links to Ask Silver's own WhatsApp service. It describes screenshot checking and an optional one-tap report to authorities. Its listed onboarding uses a one-time email/QR code. Results can be wrong; remove personal and financial details before uploading. Read the official Get Safe Online instructions. [28]

SMS: forward suspicious texts to 7726

Forward the original suspicious SMS to 7726, free of charge; follow any request for the sender's number. This alerts your mobile provider. For a suspicious mobile call, text Call followed by the caller's number. WhatsApp messages and social adverts use different routes; 7726 is not a general website-reporting inbox. [27]

Report inside the app where you saw it

Instagram / Facebook advert	Use the advert's reporting menu and retain its identifier and decision. This notifies the platform. [10]
WhatsApp scam message	Use the message/chat Report control and follow the prompts. This reports it to WhatsApp. [25]
Website reached from an advert	Use the NCSC website form and, where relevant, the provider's abuse route. Add the original advert link. [6]

Keep the two jobs distinct: getting help to assess an offer, and notifying the organisation responsible for acting. Aletheia can prepare the evidence and verified destination; the user chooses the channel and sends or submits the report.

Make the right thing easy

The useful output is a recipient, a subject, the facts and a short request. You decide what to send.

Ask Aletheia Trust Check for a report pack

TRUST SCAM [URL or pasted advert]. Jurisdiction: UK.
Check the evidence. Give me the verified provider reporting email or official form, its source and checked date; a short subject and report I can copy; and any essential missing evidence. Separate what I observed from what others reported. Include the full target URL. Do not send anything.

This uses the existing method's draft-on-request capability. A useful interface improvement would put Copy recipient, Copy report, Open official form and verified mobile routes beside the result, with the source and checked date. These controls are a proposal here. [1]

A short provider notice

To: [verified provider address, or official form]
Subject: Suspected deceptive advert / website - [domain or ad ID]

I am reporting suspected abuse involving [exact URL / ad ID], seen on [service] at [date, time and time zone].

What I observed: [exact claim or conduct, with evidence reference].
Why this needs review: [specific inconsistency or suspected policy/law breach; explain any uncertainty].
Evidence: [ad link, destination URL, dated captures or other records]. [State clearly if details are source-reported and not personally verified.]

Please acknowledge this report, investigate the content and relevant advertiser/customer account, and take appropriate action under your policies and applicable law. Please preserve relevant records where lawful and provide a reference and available outcome/review route.

[Name and reply details supplied privately]

Keep the essentials in the message body. A report may not be able to rely on attachments. Do not include passwords, full card details or unrelated personal records. Keep originals privately and redact copies used for public discussion.

Sharing through WhatsApp

Share the PDF or a redacted summary: "I found an advert with claims that need checking. Here is the evidence and the official reporting route. Please assess it before buying or sharing." Sharing is public awareness, not delivery of an official complaint. For a suspicious message within WhatsApp, use its built-in Report control. [25]

How the cloak can come off

The provider's role and the applicable law determine what follows from notice.

1 / Conditional intermediary protections

The UK Electronic Commerce Regulations distinguish conduit, caching and hosting. For hosting, regulation 19 concerns relevant knowledge/awareness and expeditious removal or disabling. Regulation 20 preserves court and administrative remedies. Caching has a different test; the hosting rule does not automatically cover every CDN or platform function. [5]

Under regulation 22, relevant notice details include the sender's full name/address, the information's location and why it is unlawful, plus the contact route used. Give appropriate identity details privately through a verified channel when seeking to establish legal knowledge. An anonymous tip may carry different weight. [5]

2 / Consumer enforcement can act now

The DMCC unfair-trading rules apply to practices from 6 April 2025. False time-limited availability is a banned practice. The CMA can impose consumer-law fines up to 10% of worldwide turnover (with a £300,000 alternative where higher). The conduct, responsible trader and legal scope still need to be established. [17] [18] [23]

A concrete example: on 14 October 2026 the CMA announced a £4.8 million fine for Wayfair over false time-limited offers and a £1.2 million fine for Appliances Direct covering misleading sales tactics. These are separate enforcement cases, not evidence about the denture advert. [18]

3 / Paid scam-ad rules are still being finalised

As checked on 30 October 2026, Ofcom's fraudulent-advertising consultation had closed and was marked "Pending Statement". A statement was planned by mid-2027 at the latest. The proposed codes cover Category 1 and 2A services and require the remaining approval/commencement steps. Do not present these proposals as fully operational today. Ofcom identifies potential fines of £18 million or 10% of global revenue, whichever is higher, under the enforcement regime. [15] [16]

Prosecution requires an offence. A provider policy breach, a missed complaint or loss of a liability protection is not automatically a criminal conviction. Police investigate; prosecutors and courts apply the relevant offence and evidence. Lawful demands may obtain identifying records that a member of the public cannot require a provider to disclose. [5] [24]

Build a record that survives the advert

The target is a fair, traceable response - and effective action against repeat abuse.

Preserve the evidence of notification

1. Capture. Save the advert ID/link, advertiser, destination, exact claim, time zone and dated evidence. Keep the ad and landing page connected.
2. Notify. Use the correct inbox or form. Keep the sent message/submission, acknowledgement, reference and any decision. Sending alone does not prove it was read.
3. Check the outcome. If you encounter it again, record the later date and identifier. Explain changes. Similar graphics, a shared CDN or copied text do not prove the same operator.
4. Escalate the pattern. Give the appropriate authority the evidence, notice history and continuing harm. Ask for a review of the service's systems and repeat-advertiser controls.

Ofcom uses individual reports as regulatory intelligence and cannot order a specific takedown through an individual complaint. Eligible organisations can bring an online-safety super-complaint; an individual or a new app does not automatically qualify. EU-facing cases may also have DSA notice, appeal and regulator routes, subject to EU scope and eligibility. [19] [20]

What a cleaner internet should require

Our proposals: a visible reporting route; meaningful advertiser verification; decisions linked to evidence; checks for repeat abuse across replacement accounts; preservation of relevant records; and transparent measures of response and recurrence. These are design and policy demands, not a claim that every detail is already required by law.

> Measure outcomes honestly. Track reports sent, acknowledgements, decisions, removals and reappearances separately. Report "no visible action as of [date]" when that is all you know. An inaccessible page is not proof of a successful takedown.

Publication needs the same discipline. Gemini's assurances that nobody would sue and that reporting is always "100% protected" were unsound. England/Wales defences such as truth, honest opinion and public interest have legal conditions. A "suspected" label does not cure an unsupported accusation. Attribute claims, retain evidence, correct errors and offer a fair opportunity to respond. [21]

Speak up. Give the facts. Keep the receipt. Aletheia Trust Check can help make that ordinary act easier. Businesses and regulators then have a clearer record on which to act.

Sources you can follow

Checked 30 October 2026. Numbered citations and source titles are clickable.

01 Aletheia Trust Check v0.5.1
github.com

02 AWS: report abuse of resources
repost.aws

03 AWS Acceptable Use Policy
aws.amazon.com

04 AWS: CloudFront URL formats
docs.aws.amazon.com

05 UK Electronic Commerce Regulations
legislation.gov.uk

06 NCSC: suspicious websites
ncsc.gov.uk

07 Report Fraud: reporting options
reportfraud.police.uk

08 ASA: report an online scam ad
asa.org.uk

09 Google: how to report an ad
support.google.com

10 Meta Safety Centre: scams
meta.com

11 CMA: report a problem
gov.uk

12 MHRA: non-compliant devices
gov.uk

13 Citizens Advice: Trading Standards
citizensadvice.org.uk

14 Ofcom: online complaints
ofcom.org.uk

15 Ofcom: fraudulent advertising
ofcom.org.uk

16 Ofcom: scam advert proposals
ofcom.org.uk

17 CMA: unfair commercial practices
gov.uk

18 CMA: October 2026 penalties
gov.uk

19 Ofcom: super-complaints
ofcom.org.uk

20 EU: rights under the DSA
digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu

21 Defamation Act 2013
legislation.gov.uk

22 Ofcom: advertising design audit
ofcom.org.uk

23 CMA: business guide to the rules
gov.uk

24 AWS: lawful information requests
aws.amazon.com

25 Report Fraud: suspicious activity
reportfraud.police.uk

26 AWS Registrar: abuse contacts
aws.amazon.com

27 Ofcom: SMS and app-message reports
ofcom.org.uk

28 Get Safe Online: Ask Silver
getsafeonline.org

29 Metro Bank: WhatsApp Scam Checker
metrobankonline.co.uk

Scope: UK-focused public guide, with limited EU context. The supplied Gemini transcript is a case lead, not independently verified incident evidence. The original ad, complete ad link, original captures and buyer records were unavailable; target-page retrieval failed. Official legal, regulator and provider sources were reviewed; some AWS/Meta direct pages restricted retrieval, so official indexed guidance and accessible official cross-references were also used.

Aletheia Protocol: provenance, uncertainty and human control. Artwork: conceptual cover generated with the built-in image tool; pattern icons are drawn illustrations. No website screenshot is presented as evidence. Report text is for human review and sending; no report was submitted in producing this guide.